TENIR

Big choices, explained

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Conceptual illustration, not a real place

PILOT EDITION · FREE

Morocco 2030

Building fast, keeping our options

Seawater to tap: what to watch p. 6

A port signed over for 25 years p. 7

An AI that speaks Darija: who stays in charge? p. 8

What we build today, we will live with tomorrow

By 2030, Morocco is building fast: desalination, trains, ports, artificial intelligence. These projects will change daily life, from the water in our taps to the way we travel.

Some choices commit us for twenty-five years or more. The further we go, the more a correction costs.

The question is not: "should we build?"

The question is: "what will we still be able to correct?"

This magazine does not grade projects. It shows what is known, what is not known yet, and what we can ask.

Aziz Skiredj, TENIR Labs, Casablanca

IN THIS ISSUE

03 The essentials
04 Morocco builds fast
05 Hard-to-undo choices
06 Seawater to tap
07 Ports and trains
08 An AI that speaks Darija
09 A loan in two steps
10 Before signing
11 Quiz and sources

HOW TO READ THIS MAGAZINE

FACT	Checked, with its source on page 11.
WHAT WE THINK	Our reading of the facts. Open to debate.
WHAT WE SUGGEST	An idea to discuss, not a truth.

The essentials in 90 seconds

1 FACT

Major projects are moving on several fronts at once: water, rail, ports, energy, artificial intelligence.

2 FACT

Some commitments last a very long time: the west terminal of Nador West Med port is granted for 25 years.

3 WHAT WE THINK

The real risk is not building. It is losing the ability to correct course if an assumption turns out wrong.

THE QUESTION TO REMEMBER

Before the next signature, what can still be changed, and who will be able to decide?

Morocco is building fast

FACT

Four projects, four markers. These are announced budgets and targets, not results.

WATER

420

million m³ a year

of desalinated seawater today. Target: 1.7 billion.

Minister of Equipment and Water, May 2026

RAIL

96

billion dirhams

for rail by 2030, including 168 new trains.

ONCF

PORT

25

year concession

for the west terminal of Nador West Med. €280m for phase 1.

Marsa Maroc, 2025

AI

200,000

people to train

or certify by 2030. 50,000 jobs targeted.

Morocco AI 2030 roadmap

What these figures don’t say yet

A target is not a result. A capacity is not a service. A budget is not value created. A concession is not proof of traffic.

Why some choices are hard to undo

WHAT WE THINK

A big decision is like a road that forks. At the start, you can still take another way. The further you go, the more turning back costs.



At the start After signing After construction

1 **The contract.** Getting out has a price.

2 **The money.** Once spent or borrowed, it may not come back.

3 **The technology.** Switching suppliers takes time.

4 **The organisation.** Teams and budgets follow one choice.

5 **The public promise.** An announced project becomes a symbol.

WHAT WE SUGGEST

A simple test: if a key assumption turns out wrong tomorrow, what can be changed first? Not stopping everything: knowing where the exits are, who holds the key, and how long it takes to open them.

Seawater to tap

FACT

Facing drought, Morocco is betting on desalination: turning seawater into drinking water. In May 2026, the Minister of Equipment and Water announced 420 million m³ a year, with the aim of reaching 1.7 billion.

A plant is not enough. For the water to reach your home, you also need:

- electricity, and lots of it
- pipes all the way to the cities
- maintenance, every year
- managing the salt sent back to sea

WHAT WE THINK

Announced capacity is not the water running from your tap. What to watch: the volume actually delivered, in the right place, at a bearable price.

WHAT WE SUGGEST

Before each expansion, publish the full cost per m³ and scenarios: drought, energy prices, demand.

Choices for the long run

The port

FACT

At Nador West Med, the west terminal is granted to Marsa Maroc for 25 years. First phase: €280 million, with operations planned from 2027.

WHAT WE THINK

A quay does not guarantee ships. A port is worth the roads, rail and customers it really attracts. Is the expected traffic new, or taken from another port?

The train

FACT

ONCF is running a MAD 96 billion programme to 2030 and expects nearly 100 million passengers in 2030, up from 55.6 million in 2025.

WHAT WE THINK

A passenger forecast is an assumption. It is worth comparing, year after year, with actual ridership.

To ask at every update

Which assumption has changed? Which cost has become irreversible? What happens if traffic stays below the forecast?

An AI that speaks Darija: who stays in charge?

FACT

The “Morocco AI 2030” roadmap, unveiled in January 2026, targets 50,000 jobs and 200,000 trained people. On 29 September 2026, the Ministry of Digital Transition and Mistral AI presented two first open-source tools for Darija.

WHAT WE THINK

Real progress, which lets us ask three questions that apply to any AI used by a public service:

1

Where does it run?

On which machines, in which country.

2

Who handles the data?

Who can read, move or delete it.

3

Who can stop it?

Who changes its rules, halts an action, restarts it.

Hosting it in Morocco answers the first question, not necessarily the other two.

WHAT WE SUGGEST

When an AI touches a right or a budget, an authorised person must be able to stop and review its decision.

A loan for water, in two steps

FACT

In July 2026, the European Bank for Reconstruction and Development (EBRD) approved a loan of up to €250 million to ONEE, to modernise drinking-water production and cut water losses.

Part A
€120m
committed

Part B
€130m
uncommitted

plus a €5m grant

WHAT WE THINK

This split creates a useful checkpoint: before committing the second part, things can be checked.

What we know

- The amounts and the purpose of the programme
- An environmental and social review planned for part B
- Its works can be adapted

What we don't know yet

- When part B will be decided
- Which works will be chosen
- What a change would cost

This page describes public documents. It does not judge the project. TENIR has not contacted ONEE or the EBRD.

Two questions to ask before signing

1 Will there be time to correct?

Compare the time left before signing with the time needed to spot a problem, decide and fix it.

IMAGINARY EXAMPLE

45 days before signing, 52 days to correct: 7 days short. Move the date, shrink the order or correct faster.

2 How much money goes out before the proof?

The amount you could no longer recover if you sign before checking the essentials: demand, energy prices, a grid connection.

And if it can't be calculated?

We say so, and we name the missing documents: a published unknown is better than invented precision. For the projects in this issue, public documents are not enough.

Two measures proposed by TENIR, still experimental. They are not official ratings.

True or false?

1 Announced desalination capacity is the water that reaches your tap.

☐ **True** ☐ **False**

2 The west terminal of Nador West Med is granted for 25 years.

☐ **True** ☐ **False**

3 Hosting an AI in Morocco is enough to stay in charge of its decisions.

☐ **True** ☐ **False**

4 The EBRD loan to ONEE is fully committed.

☐ **True** ☐ **False**

Answers: 1 False (p. 6) · 2 True (p. 7) · 3 False (p. 8) · 4 False (p. 9)

OUR SOURCES

Water: maroc.ma, 6 May 2026, statement by the Minister of Equipment and Water.

Rail: ONCF; Le360, 27 October 2026.

Port: Marsa Maroc and Tanger Med, 2025 releases.

AI: Ministry of Digital Transition, January and September 2026; announcement with Mistral AI, 29 September 2026.

ONEE loan: EBRD, project 57587 and Board report, July 2026.

Full links and corrections: tenirlabs.cc/n01. Checked on 9 November 2026. Reported errors are corrected online, with their date.

This issue is a trial. Your view decides what comes next.

Was this magazine useful to you?

Yes | A little | No

Which topic for the next issue?

Water | Transport | School and digital | Jobs | Energy

Which language do you prefer?

English | Français | العربية

Scan to answer

Answer in one minute

or at tenirlabs.cc/n01

A big project near you? Tell us which one: it could be explained in a future issue.

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